

Japan Electronic Components: Asia investor visit: MLCC stocks (Murata/Taiyo Yuden) in focus as well as Ibiden/TDK/Nitto Denko

We visited Singapore last week and held many investor meetings. Discussions on individual stocks covered Ibiden (Buy; ABF substrates), TDK (Buy, on CL; rechargeable batteries), Nitto Denko (Buy; optical films), Murata Mfg. and Taiyo Yuden (both Buy; MLCCs), and laggards Renesas Electronics and Nidec (both Buy), as well as Rohm (Neutral), MinebeaMitsumi (Buy), and Kyocera (Buy). **We believe that, against the backdrop of accelerating AI expansion, a wave of technological change (especially the secondary effects of rising power consumption) are also surging into the Japanese electronic components/semiconductor sector, and that the positive impact is likely to strengthen toward FY26.** From this perspective, we explained that (1) as core stocks in the sector, in addition to Ibiden and TDK, we added Nitto Denko to our list of Buy-rated stocks, and (2) the risk of not holding Murata Mfg. and Taiyo Yuden is increasing, given the possibility of tight MLCC supply/demand in 2026 (see our October 2 report for our latest earnings estimates and ratings: [LINK](#)).

Our impression is that interest in the sector has increased compared to six months ago. In terms of individual stocks, feedback was as follows: (A) compared to the highly recognized Ibiden and TDK, there is relative room for improvement in Nitto Denko's relative positioning; (B) there was considerable interest in the possibility of tight MLCC supply/demand as this is not yet the consensus view, and in this context discussions on Murata Mfg. and Taiyo Yuden were the most frequent during this investor visit; (C) most investors had a wait-and-see stance on Renesas and Nidec; and (D) many investors had a relatively positive stance on Rohm and MinebeaMitsumi, and were waiting for the next catalyst for Kyocera.

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Price Target Risks and Methodology

Exhibit 1: Target Price and Methodology

Company Name	Ticker	Analyst	Rating	Price (As of 10/14)	Target Price	Upside/Downside	TP Methodology
Ibiden	4062.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	9,778	10,600	8%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying +20% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
NGK Insulators	5333.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	2,430	2,400	-1%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -30% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Niterra	5334.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	5,858	5,700	-3%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -20% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
MinebeaMitsumi Inc.	6479.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	2,807	3,300	18%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Mabuchi Motor	6592.T	Daiki Takayama	Sell	2,517	2,300	-9%	Our target price is based on FY12/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Nidec	6594.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	2,537	3,500	38%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying +50% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Renesas Electronics	6723.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	1,711	2,500	46%	Our target price is based on FY12/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying EV/DACF multiple of 12X.
TDK	6762.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy*	2,140	2,400	12%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Alps Alpine	6770.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	1,824	2,000	10%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -40% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Hirose Electric	6806.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	18,555	18,900	2%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Japan Aviation Electronics Industry	6807.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	2,422	2,600	7%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -40% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Rohm	6963.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	2,250	2,300	2%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -20% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Kyocera	6971.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	1,960	2,400	22%	Our target price is based on P/B-ROE correlation (FY3/27E basis)
Taiyo Yuden	6976.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	3,348	3,800	14%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Murata Mfg.	6981.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	2,723	3,300	21%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying +20% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Nitto Denko	6988.T	Daiki Takayama	Buy	3,650	4,000	10%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying +20% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Nichicon	6996.T	Daiki Takayama	Neutral	1,380	1,500	9%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying -20% discount to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
MARUWA	5344.T	Mitsuhiro Icho	Buy	39,220	48,000	22%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying +80% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Maxell Ltd.	6810.T	Mitsuhiro Icho	Sell	2,046	1,800	-12%	Our target price is based on a P/B of 0.7X (FY3/27E)
IRISO Electronics	6908.T	Mitsuhiro Icho	Neutral	2,894	2,800	-3%	Our target price is based on FY3/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Nippon Ceramic	6929.T	Mitsuhiro Icho	Sell	3,380	3,000	-11%	Our target price is based on FY12/27E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, in-line with our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 8X.
Kohoku Kogyo	6524.T	Mitsuhiro Icho	Buy	3,160	4,000	27%	Our target price is calculated using a 10-year DCF model (terminal growth rate of 0%)

*denotes stock is on the APAC Conviction List. Target prices are on a 12-month basis.

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Risks

Ticker	Company Name	Key Risks
6770	Alps Alpine	Key risks include forex fluctuations and changes in auto production.
6929	Nippon Ceramic	Greater-than-expected increase in automobile production, increase in the number of ultrasonic sensors installed per vehicle, emergence of sales growth for current sensors, additional share buybacks, and forex swings.
6908	Iriso Electronics	Changes in automobile production volume, changes in materials and distribution costs, changes in plant operations, changes in the competitive environment in growth fields like connectors for automotive powertrains, forex swings.
6594	Nidec	Slower-than-expected recovery in auto production volume, a greater-than-expected slowdown in the European economy, tougher competition in the water cooling module business, a further rise in materials prices.
6479	MinebeaMitsumi	Sharper-than-expected rises in input costs, a decline in auto production, and yen appreciation.
6807	Japan Aviation Electronics Industry	Sharp yen depreciation/appreciation, auto production increases/decreases, and fluctuations in smartphone demand.
6996	Nichicon	Exchange rate fluctuations, changes in demand, material costs, and power costs for aluminum electrolytic capacitors, fluctuations in EV market volumes, and the impact of subsidies.
6988	Nitto Denko	A stronger yen, a decline in demand for smartphones/PCs/tablets, etc., and changes or delays to clinical schedules in the life science business.
6762	TDK	Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.
6806	Hirose Electric	Greater-than-expected yen appreciation/depreciation, changes in smartphone and auto production.
5334	Niterra	Changes in auto production, input cost fluctuations, the speed of new business development, and forex swings.
4062	Ibiden	Road map changes of main customers, weaker PC and server demand, and a reduction in diesel vehicle sales
6976	Taiyo Yuden	Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.
6592	Mabuchi Motor	Stronger-than-expected auto production volume, a decline in input costs, and yen depreciation.
5344	MARUWA	A decline in investment in applications that support end demand, such as AI/general-purpose servers, xEVs, and semiconductor manufacturing equipment; a decline in end product demand due to supply chain disruptions and inventory adjustments; the emergence of substitute technologies.
6981	Murata Mfg.	A decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.
5333	NGK Insulators	Forex fluctuation, auto production volatility, and pace of the recovery in the semiconductor cycle.
6971	Kyocera	Slower-than-expected progress on planned management changes, inefficient investment or deployment of surplus capital, a delayed cycle recovery, and yen appreciation.
6524	Kohoku Kogyo	Optical components and devices business: Decline in demand for major end-use products (automobiles, telecommunications equipment such as communication stations, industrial machinery, home appliances, etc.) Lead terminals business: Sudden changes in the schedule of telecom submarine cable laying projects, reactionary decline in demand due to excessive component production for telecom submarine cable laying companies. Company-wide: FX fluctuations, political instability in major production locations such as Sri Lanka and Dongguan in China
6810	Maxell, Ltd.	A greater-than-expected recovery in automobile output, increased adoption of the company's automotive products, acceleration in margin improvement for consumer electronics products, lower costs relating to projector business downsizing, and yen depreciation.
6963	Rohm	Forex fluctuations, changes in auto production, changes in consumer electronics production, competition with local Chinese manufacturers, and the degree to which restructuring efforts are successful
6723	Renesas Electronics	A slowdown or delayed recovery in consumer electronics-related demand, stagnant automobile production, protracted reduction in semiconductor inventories, delayed recovery for industrial equipment applications, and yen appreciation

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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